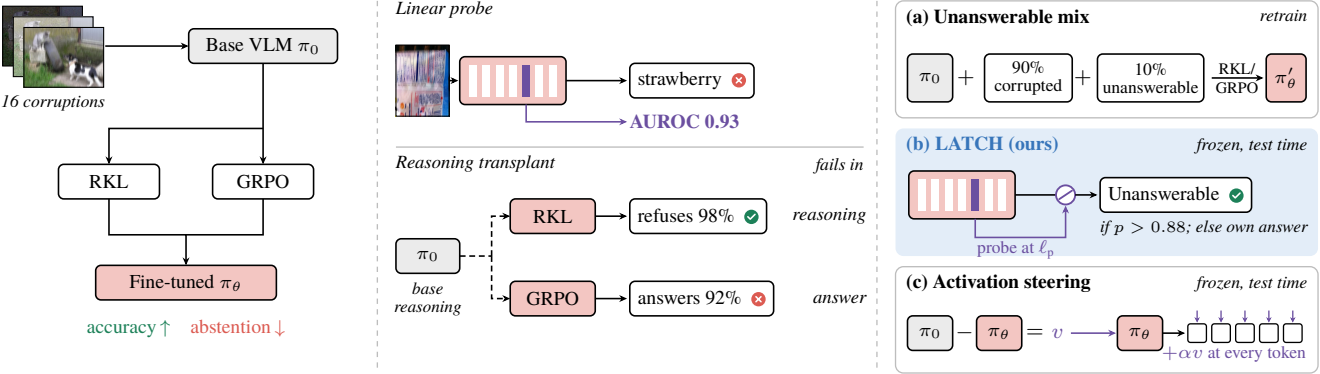

❶ Robust fine-tuning
16 corruptions
Base VLM π_0
RKL
GRPO
Fine-tuned π_θ
accuracy ↑
abstention ↓
❷ Diagnose
Linear probe
strawberry
AUROC 0.93
Reasoning transplant
fails in
π_0
base reasoning
RKL
refuses 98%
reasoning
GRPO
answers 92%
answer
❸ Recover abstention
(a) Unanswerable mix
retrain
π_0
90% corrupted
10% unanswerable
RKL/ GRPO
π'_θ
(b) LATCH (ours)
frozen, test time
Unanswerable
if $p > 0.88$; else own answer
probe at ℓ_p
(c) Activation steering
frozen, test time
π_0
π_θ
$= v$
π_θ
$+\alpha v$ at every token